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COURSE TITLE - DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT TITLE - DIGITAL AWARENESS

Introduction: Digital Literacy Project

The Digital Literacy project aims to develop essential skills for responsible and effective use of digital technology in academic and professional environments. In today's world, students must not only be able to use digital tools but also maintain a professional online presence, practice safe internet habits, communicate clearly, and manage data securely. This project covers five key areas: creating informative presentations, building a professional portfolio on platforms like LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle, practicing coding and collaboration tools, understanding proper email etiquette, and learning about cybercrime prevention. Through these tasks, students engage in practical exercises such as designing infographics, setting up profiles, completing coding challenges, creating forms, and preparing safety checklists. The scenario simulates real-world digital interactions and challenges that students may encounter, helping them build awareness, skills, and habits that promote efficiency, security, and professionalism in an increasingly digital academic and workplace environment.

TASK 1 REPORT

For this task, I used Canva, a free online design tool, to create an infographic summarizing key aspects of digital literacy. The design focuses on three main topics: what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, and safe internet practices. I selected a visually appealing template and customized it with icons, colors, and short text blocks to clearly convey the information. The infographic highlights the importance of understanding digital skills, using productivity and collaboration tools like Google Workspace and Canva itself, and practicing safe internet habits such as strong passwords, verifying information, and avoiding phishing scams. By combining visuals and text, the design makes the information easy to understand and engaging for the viewer. One interesting part of creating this infographic was learning how to organize information visually so that it's both clear and attractive. It was slightly challenging to condense all the information into a single slide without overcrowding it, but this helped me improve my design and content prioritization skills. Overall, Canva made it easy to produce a professional-looking infographic with minimal effort.

TASK 2 REPORT

For this task, I created and updated profiles on LinkedIn, Kaggle, and GitHub to establish a professional online presence and explore digital collaboration tools. On LinkedIn, I filled in my education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that allows me to connect with peers, mentors, and potential employers. Over the next four years, I plan to use LinkedIn to follow industry trends, participate in groups, and build a network that will support my career growth. On Kaggle, I set up a profile to access datasets, participate in competitions, and improve my data analysis and machine learning skills. Kaggle is primarily used for learning and practicing data science, and I plan to actively work on projects and competitions to develop practical skills that complement my coursework. On GitHub, I created a profile README with my name, branch, year, and a short statement about what I hope to learn. GitHub is a platform for version control and collaborative coding. I will use it to host projects, track progress, and showcase my coding work over the next four years. These platforms collectively help me build a professional presence, develop skills, and document my learning journey in a digital portfolio.

TASK 3 REPORT

For Part A, I created an account on HackerRank to practice coding and improve my problem-solving skills. I completed a beginner-level challenge called “Solve Me First”, which involved writing a simple program to perform addition of two numbers. Completing this challenge helped me understand the process of writing, testing, and submitting code in an online environment. I also received immediate feedback on my solution, which is valuable for learning and improving programming logic. A screenshot of the completed challenge, along with my score, was saved for the project. For Part B, I used Google Workspace to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates. The form included exactly five questions, with at least one multiple choice and one short answer question. After sharing the form, I collected responses in a linked Google Sheet and took screenshots of both the form and the response sheet to include in the project folder. Using HackerRank and Google Workspace together helped me develop both technical and collaborative skills. HackerRank strengthens my coding and logical thinking, while Google Forms and Sheets enhance my ability to create assessments, collect data, and collaborate effectively. These tools will support my academic growth by improving practical problem-solving, project organization, and digital literacy.

TASK 4 REPORT

A common situation where poor digital communication caused a problem involved a student group project. One team member sent an email to the group with unclear instructions about submission deadlines and file formats. As a result, some members submitted the wrong files and others missed the deadline entirely, which led to confusion and a lower group grade. This situation could have been avoided by writing a clear, structured email that included the exact deadline, file naming conventions, and responsibilities of each member. Using bullet points, a polite tone, and a clear subject line would have ensured that all recipients understood the instructions. Additionally, following up with a short reminder before the deadline and confirming receipt would have improved communication. Clear digital communication is essential to avoid misunderstandings and ensure smooth collaboration.

TASK 5 REPORT

While researching online safety, I was most surprised by how many college students unknowingly expose themselves to scams, phishing, and financial fraud through careless use of social media and UPI apps. Many people share personal information or click on suspicious links without realizing the risks. One habit I will personally change is never saving UPI PINs or sharing OTPs, even with close friends, and double-checking all payment requests before approving them. The process of creating a “Stay Safe Online” checklist helped me understand the importance of practical, actionable steps to protect both personal and financial data. Reporting channels like the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline 1930 are essential for quickly addressing cyber threats. By following these precautions, students can reduce risks while enjoying the benefits of digital technology.

Conclusion: Learning from the Digital Literacy Project

Working on all five tasks of this project has significantly improved my digital literacy, professional presence, and online safety awareness. Creating presentations in Canva enhanced my ability to communicate information visually. Setting up LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle profiles taught me the importance of professional networking and showcasing skills. Practicing coding on HackerRank and using Google Forms strengthened problem-solving and collaboration abilities. Learning proper email etiquette highlighted the impact of clear communication. Researching cybercrime and creating a prevention checklist emphasized the need for safe online habits. Overall, these tasks have equipped me with practical skills and responsible digital practices for academic and professional growth.

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